

```
SECONDS_PER_WEEK    = 7 * SECONDS_PER_DAY
# fmt: on
```

Running Black on this file now won't affect the unique spacing, or any other formatting, in the code between these two comments.

Summary

Although good formatting can be invisible, poor formatting can make reading code frustrating. Style is subjective, but the software development field generally agrees on what constitutes good and poor formatting while still leaving room for personal preferences.

Python's syntax makes it rather flexible when it comes to style. If you're writing code that nobody else will ever see, you can write it however you like. But much of software development is collaborative. Whether you're working with others on a project or simply want to ask more experienced developers to review your work, formatting your code to fit accepted style guides is important.

Formatting your code in an editor is a boring task that you can automate with a tool like Black. This chapter covered several of the guidelines that Black follows to make your code more readable, including spacing code vertically and horizontally, which keeps it from being too dense to read easily, and setting a limit on how long each line should be. Black enforces these rules for you, preventing potential style arguments with collaborators.

But there's more to code style than spacing and deciding between single and double quotes. For instance, choosing descriptive variable names is also a critical factor for code readability. Although automated tools like Black can make *syntactic* decisions, such as the amount of spacing code should have, they can't make *semantic* decisions, such as what a good variable name is. That responsibility is yours, and we'll discuss this topic in the next chapter.